

THE
COMMUNICATIONS
AND ELECTRONICS BRANCH

95 CRAFTSMAN BOULEVARD
CFB KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4



BRANCHE
DES COMMUNICATIONS
ET DE L'ÉLECTRONIQUE

95 CRAFTSMAN BOULEVARD
BFC KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4

1180-5 (Br Adjt)

June 2024

Distribution List

SENATE MEETING
RECORD OF DECISIONS – FRIDAY, 27 OCTOBER 2023

RECORD OF ATTENDANCE

POSITION / APPOINTMENT	RANK & NAME
Chair / Colonel Commandant	Brigadier-General(ret'd) Josée Robidoux
Co-Chair / Branch Leader	Brigadier-General Dave Yarker
Member / Previous Branch Leader	Brigadier-General(ret'd) James Lambert (regrets)
Member / Previous Colonel Commandant	Brigadier-General(ret'd) Kevin O'Keefe
Member / Branch Advisor	Colonel John Roper
Member / Branch Chief	Chief Warrant Officer Alex Arndt
Member / Association President	Major-General(ret'd) John Leech
Member / Foundation President	Lieutenant-Colonel(ret'd) Scott Mclean (regrets)
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Denis Boucher
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Pascal Godbout
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Walter Norquay
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Mark Parsons (regrets)
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Justin Thibert (regrets)
Member / Honorary Rep	Honorary Colonel Ken Lloyd
Member / CO C&E Museum	Lieutenant-Colonel Geniève Audet
Guest / Museum Rep	Ms. Karen Young
Secretariat / Branch Adjutant	Major Gavin Ellis

OPENING REMARKS
1. The Colonel Commandant (Col Cmdt) opened the meeting at 1300 and offered initial opening remarks to the Branch Leader and Branch Chief who noted that C&E week has offered excellent professional development opportunities for those in attendance though additional attendees would be beneficial to the program.
REVIEW & APPROVAL OF PRIOR ROD
2. Previous minutes were reviewed by the Senate members and several changes were requested prior to approval. Approval of minutes will occur at the next Senate meeting.
OLD BUSINESS I – BOOK OF REMEMBRANCE
3. BGen(ret'd) O'Keefe is working to identify individuals for inclusion in our 2nd Book of Remembrance, but it has been challenging to reconcile various lists, especially since the RCCS Book does not include seventeen personnel who died from wartime injuries in 1946/47 or the 69 RCAF Telecom personnel who died during WWII. Rick Draffin, a professional calligrapher with a global reputation, has volunteered to assist with the design and preparation of the Book, which would otherwise be costly. BGen(ret'd) O'Keefe has proposed that the Book resembles the existing RCCS Book and includes an addendum for those who died before 1968, commemorating their sacrifices. The challenge lies in gaining access to the existing Book in the Museum for Mr. Draffin to assess, despite the Museum's artefact policy, although similar access has been granted for other national treasures. Action: Museum Director to determine access requirements for artifacts held by within the collection. Action: An agenda item will be added to the next Senate meeting to discuss requirements for inclusion into the Book of Remembrance.
OLD BUSINESS II – C&E EDUCATIONAL BURSARIES
4. The previous task of reviewing the Branch Bursary policy within all pertinent documents has been completed by the Branch Office. The Bursary information has been reviewed, updated, and amended on within the standing orders, CMCEN and bursary application SOP. This item is now considered closed.
OLD BUSINESS III – TIMELINE FOR H&R
5. The Branch office has reviewed all honours maintained by the Branch to determine if their submission processes were sufficiently efficient as to minimize staff work by units. Apart from the Education Bursaries and Subaltern/Member of the Year applications all others use DND standard processes and forms. This item is now considered closed.

OLD BUSINESS IV – RCEME MOU

6. The RCEME MOU has been signed by all parties and is now in effect. This item is now considered closed.

OLD BUSINESS V – BRANCH COMMS PLAN

7. An update to the Branch Comms Plan was provided by the Branch Advisor indicating that the C&E Branch Comms plan will involve the CIO Group comms team for support. There is concern about how the Branch is communicating with troops due to a lack of deliverable products, suggesting a survey might help. Fact-finding visits to branch units are needed, and the Colonel Commandant will consult with other Colonels Commandants to determine the best approach with the chief's support.

Action: Branch office to investigate the stand of three events: eSport league, Super Jimmy Day 2024, and a Capture the Flag Event.

NEW BUSINESS I – MUSEUM REPORT

8. The Commandant of CFSCE briefed on Museum changes using the slide deck available in Annex A. The following points of note were made:
 - a. Funding from DHH has been inconsistent and the museum can not reliably depend on it;
 - b. Increased diverse representation that includes members and historical figures from a variety of racial and cultural backgrounds would benefit the museum.
 - c. **Approved:** Request to open 7 days a week from Canada Day to Labour Day
 - d. **Approved:** Creation of an Indigenously designed Memorial Garden on museum grounds

Action: Museum Director to provide updated budget to include impact of not hiring members this spring.

Action: Museum Director to provide update on Volunteer policy and way forward to leverage the community who is willing to support the museum.

NEW BUSINESS II – BRANCH REPORT

9. The Branch Adjutant provided a summary of the financial status and proposed FY 24/25 budget for the office. The following points of action were brought forward by members:
 - a. Note that the Association has distress funds available for members should they be required.

Action: Branch Office, translate of all Branch documents look at different options of conducting the translation.

Action: Branch Office, plan a Super Jimmy Day for spring 2024 and continue scheduling them throughout the year. Super Jimmy Day in July 2023 was a success and brought together core components of the branch.

Action: Branch Office, establishing an eSport League and run a Branch wide Cyber Capture the Flag event.

NEW BUSINESS III – FOUNDATION REPORT

10. The Foundation President sent his regrets as he was unable to attend nor was a substitute available to brief the Senate.

NEW BUSINESS IV – ASSOCIATION REPORT

11. The president of the Association provided an update on the History Working Group which has numerous initiatives underway. The Association is looking for a new lead for its Memorials Project where Mr. Tony Charters has helmed the project since 2019. Additionally, the Association is once again conducting Op JIMMY SANTA to provide a gift to all C&E Members who are deployed. On reflection of this past C&E Week it was recognized that Veteran's Day was a success and should be repeated.

Action: Branch Office to include Veteran's Day in C&E Week 2024 planning.

Action: Association to provide an OPI for Veteran's Day to the Branch Office.

NEW BUSINESS V – 125th Anniversary Planning

12. A brief discussion was raised concerning the Branch's next major anniversary in 2028 that will mark the 125th for our Branch. The following recommendations and actions were suggested with follow on discussions to provide additional detail where needed.
- a. Establishment of a planning committee to include members of the retired community;
 - b. Establish a scope for the anniversary as well as for the visit of HRH.

Action: Branch Office, obtain planning details from the 8 Hussars including Lessons Learned

Action: Branch Office, find planning and lessons learned documentation from previous major anniversaries.

OPEN FORUM

13. During the open forum portion of the meeting, attendees discussed various general topics without addressing any specific actionable items. Key points highlighted include the importance of how we correspond with our members, including the vehicle, format, and length of communications. Additionally, it was noted that CMCEN could benefit from more posts and that we should continue with the technical posts we have been pushing out. Lastly, it was announced that 22 Wing North Bay has renamed their Fitness and Wellness Center after MCpl Jean-Pierre Legault.

CLOSING REMARKS

14. The Branch Leader thanked everyone for attending, expressing gratitude for the engaging conversation and excellent remarks shared during the meeting. They concluded by wishing everyone an enjoyable time at the mess dinner.

Brigadier-General(ret'd) Josée Robidoux, OMM, CD
Branch Colonel Commandant

Brigadier-General Dave Yarker, CD
Branch Leader

Annex:

Annex A Branch Senate Slide Deck

Distribution List

Action

Branch Senate Membership

Branch Office

ANNEX A: BRANCH SENATE SLIDE DECK

C&E BRANCH SENATE MEETING



Friday, 27 1300 October 2023

Slide 1

AGENDA:

- ▶ Opening Remarks (**Branch Leadership**)
- ▶ Review and Approval of Previous Minutes (**Colonel Commandant**)
- ▶ New Business I - Museum Report (**CFSCE Commandant**)
- ▶ Old Business I - Book of Remembrance - Seeking Decision (**Colonel Commandant**)
- ▶ Old Business II - C&E Educational Bursaries (**Branch Adjutant**)
- ▶ Old Business III - Timeline for H&R (**Branch Adjutant**)
- ▶ Old Business IV - RCME MOU (**Branch Advisor**)
- ▶ Old Business V - Branch Communications Plan (**Branch Advisor**)
- ▶ New Business II - Branch Report (**Branch Advisor & Branch Adjutant**)
- ▶ New Business III - Foundation Report (**Foundation President**)
- ▶ New Business IV - Association Report (**Association President**)
- ▶ New Business V - 125th Anniversary Planning (**Senate Co-Chairs**)
- ▶ Open Forum
- ▶ Closing Remarks (**ALCON**)

Slide 2

INTRODUCTORY REMARKS

- ▶ Branch Leader
- ▶ Colonel Commandant
- ▶ Branch Chief

Slide 3

Museum Update

LCol G. Audet
27 October 2023

Slide 4

Agenda

1. Brief Financial Detail
2. Museum MDF / DHH
3. Summer Hours
4. Memorial Garden



Slide 5

Brief Financial Detail

- ▶ Support in 23/24
 - ▶ Foundation, \$159K
 - ▶ CFB Kingston, \$100k direct, about \$650k in support
 - ▶ CFSCE, approx. \$200k in support (PATs and FSWEF students)
 - ▶ Mercury Shop (separate business) -break even
 - ▶ RCEME - \$36k (MOU)
 - ▶ Grants
 - ▶ Museum Development fund (MDF): \$0k
- ▶ Budget
 - ▶ FY 20-21 - \$6k deficit (approx. 50% of wages subsidized from CFMWS)-COVID
 - ▶ FY 21-22 - balanced (approx. 70% of wages subsidized from CFMWS)-COVID
 - ▶ FY 22-23 -loss (balancing budget shortfall from Foundation by using unencumbered cash) - RECOVERY
 - ▶ FY 23-24- loss(balancing budget shortfall from Foundation by using unencumbered cash)-RECOVERY
 - ▶ FY 24-25- loss (balancing budget shortfall from Foundation by using unencumbered cash) - RECOVERY

Slide 6

2024-2025 Preliminary Budget

[illegible]

Slide 7

Museum Finances are not Sustainable

- ▶ Wages are the biggest expense for the museum - The total amount of wages is not covered by the donation from the Foundation, RCME, O&M from the Base Commander in 2023-2024 (229K\$/4 positions)
- ▶ Operations costs are next highest amount - which has been partially paid with DHH money in the curatorial department including the website monthly costs
- ▶ Funds raised by staff from April -September 2023: \$5000 Canada Giving Challenge, seconded Admin. Assistant part time elsewhere (\$6000+), Sponsorship (\$1000)
- ▶ NPP Accounting will access the viability of the Museum in 2025 -2026- The Museum is at risk of being closed
- ▶ The Museum Manager requested \$228539.60 from the Foundation to cover expenses for Fiscal 2024-2025. The museum will be short **\$68000**
- ▶ We need to hire more people not less (archivist required)
- ▶ Many of the items listed as expenses in the budget for 2023 -2024 have not been done to make sure the museum does not overspend and dip into unencumbered cash

Slide 8

DHH PAST FUNDING

Fiscal Year	Amount	Money Awarded	NOTES:
2009/2010	\$20,000.00	Y	
2010/2011	\$65,000.00	Y	
2011/2012	\$280,000.00	Y	
2012/2013	\$120,000.00	Y	
2013/2014	\$52,425.00	Y	
2014/2015	\$2,700,000.00	Y	Expansion
2015/2016	\$35,000.00	Y	
2016/2017	\$90,000.00	Y	
2017/2018	0	N	No funds for anyone
2018/2019	0	N	No funds for anyone
2019/2020	\$35,000.00	Y	
2020/2021	\$115,000.00	Y	
2021/2022	\$55,000.00	Y	
2022/2023	0	N	No funds for anyone
2023/2024	?		

Slide 9

DHH in Future

- ▶ Since 2016:
 - ▶ No grant 2017
 - ▶ No grant 2018
 - ▶ No grant 2023
 - ▶ The museum expends all the funds they receive.
 - ▶ The Museum will no longer have DHH curatorial funds in reserve by 2025-2026 Fiscal year meaning project money will have to be raised from other sources
 - ▶ DHH is no longer a reliable source of funds for the museum
 - ▶ DND asked to find 1 billion dollars in savings this year

Slide 10

Museum Finances are not Sustainable

- ▶ New ways to pay for the museum will have to be found
- ▶ P070 no longer viable and there is little support for the program.
- ▶ It is unfair to expect staff to be responsible for raising their own wages.
 - ▶ Public wages for staff?
 - ▶ Charge admission for CAF members (not Veterans)?
 - ▶ Guests of CAF/Veterans no longer have free admission?
 - ▶ Foundation has to be actively fundraising to grow the endowment.
 - ▶ Other activities that divert revenue from the Foundation for the museum must be put on hold (trips, vanity publishing, etc.)
 - ▶ Seek financial support from CFMWS if possible?

Slide 11

Museum Development Fund 2022-2023

- ▶ DHH is a major source of project money for the Museum
- ▶ The Museum is ineligible for many grants as it is a federal facility
- ▶ DHH -Total request - **\$1.738M** (*approved by DHH- Not funded by CMP*)
 - ▶ Permanent Exhibit Renewal Study - \$50k
 - ▶ Display Acquisition (based on recommendations from study) - \$900k
 - ▶ Museum Storage (rolling shelves) - \$500k
 - ▶ Interpretive Panels and Signs - \$250k
 - ▶ Website Maintenance - \$10k
 - ▶ Conservation Supplies - \$25k
 - ▶ OMMC travel for 2 - \$3k

Slide 12

Museum Development Fund 2023-2024

- ▶ DHH -Resubmission of our 2022-2023 Grant (with an increase of over 100000 for the Rolling shelves) as recommended by DHH plus:
 - ▶ Line Display Renewal- \$50k
 - ▶ Special Project (Audio Tour)- \$25k
 - ▶ Special Project(Security System Replacement) \$20k
 - ▶ Outreach Program Operations (March of the Museums) \$15k
 - ▶ Educational Program Operations (Tablets for onsite students) \$5k
- ▶ Total Request 2023-2024- \$115000

Slide 13

Summer Hours

- ▶ Staying open 7 days a week from Victoria Day until Labour Day is exhausting for staff
- ▶ The Mercury Shop does not make extra money during the 4 month summer season as it has to hire weekend staff to be open 7 days a week
- ▶ Our busiest time of year for tourism is July and August
- ▶ All senior staff work at least 5 weekends a summer and also every statutory holiday
- ▶ This is expensive
- ▶ **Recommendation: That the summer hours for the museum are changed to 7 days a week as of Canada Day until Labour Day**

Slide 14

Memorial Garden

- ▶ The staff at the museum has been in discussion with the Kingston Defence Indigenous Advisory Group (KDIAG) about creating a Memorial Garden on the grounds of the Museum.
- ▶ It will be designed by an Indigenous Landscape Designer
- ▶ Funding will be raised by the museum and wider community for this (DND has \$50000 a year grant available for the next 4 fiscal years)
- ▶ RPOs and the Base are aware of the discussion
- ▶ Base has given approval if the C&E Branch agrees in principal to support
- ▶ **Recommendation: That the C&E Branch approve the the creation of an Indigenously designed Memorial Garden on the museum grounds**

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Questions

Slide 16

Old Business

- ▶ Book of Remembrance - Seeking Decision (**Colonel Commandant**)
- ▶ C&E Educational Bursaries (**Branch Adjutant**)
- ▶ Timeline for H&R (**Branch Adjutant**)
- ▶ RCEME MOU (**Branch Advisor**)
- ▶ Branch Communications Plan (**Branch Advisor**)

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New Business

- ▶ New Business II - Branch Report (**Branch Advisor & Branch Adjutant**)
- ▶ New Business III - Foundation Report (**Foundation President**)
- ▶ New Business IV - Association Report (**Association President**)
- ▶ New Business V - 125th Anniversary Planning (**Senate Co-Chairs**)

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Branch Report

► Financial Report

Item	Expenditure	Budget	Remaining
Events	\$1,000	\$2,900	\$1,900
C&E Week	\$1,300 (estimate)	\$2,500	\$1,200
Unit Celebrations	\$1,000	\$2,000	\$1,000
Funds (Distress and Education)	\$2,000	\$9,000	\$4,000 (3,000 pending for Bursaries)
Office	\$1,200	\$2,000	\$800
Totals	\$6,500	\$18,300	\$8,900

- HR
- C&E Week 2024

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C&E Branch Office Budget Proposal

► FY 24/25 Budget

- \$3,000.00 Events
- \$2,000.00 C&E Week (Oct) (C&E Branch Office)
- \$2,000.00 C&E Week - Unit Celebrations
- \$9,000.00 Funds (Distress and Education)
- \$1,000.00 Office Expenses
- \$17,000.00 Total

► Expected Cash available at End of Fiscal 23/24: ~\$6,000

► Requested funds for FY24/25: \$11,000

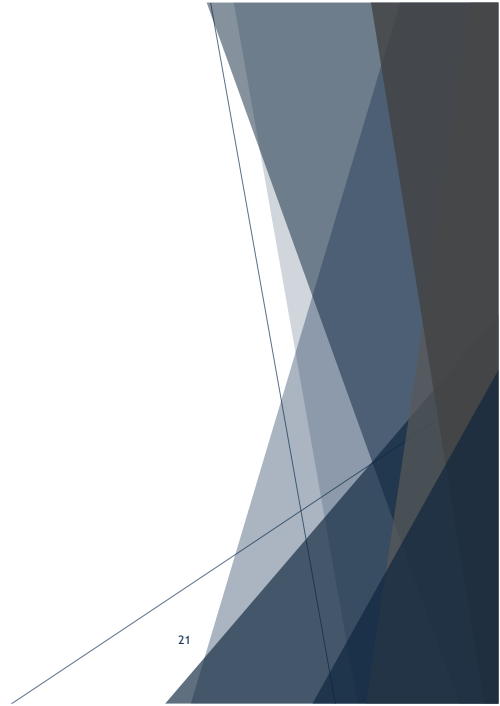
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Slide 20

Foundation Report



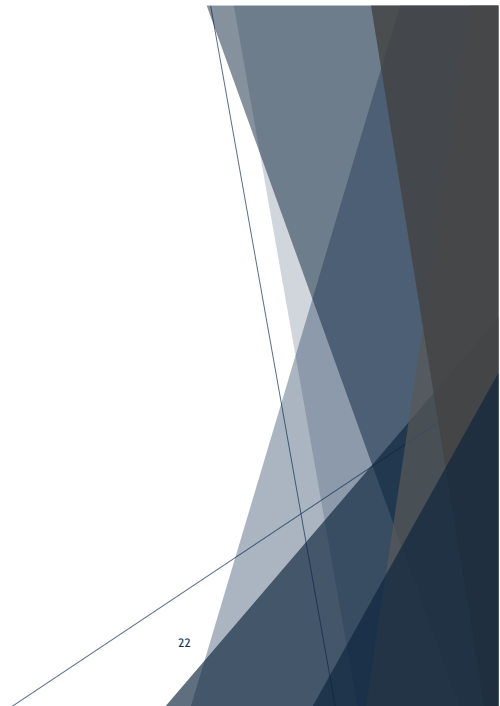
Slide 21



C&E ASSOCIATION REPORT



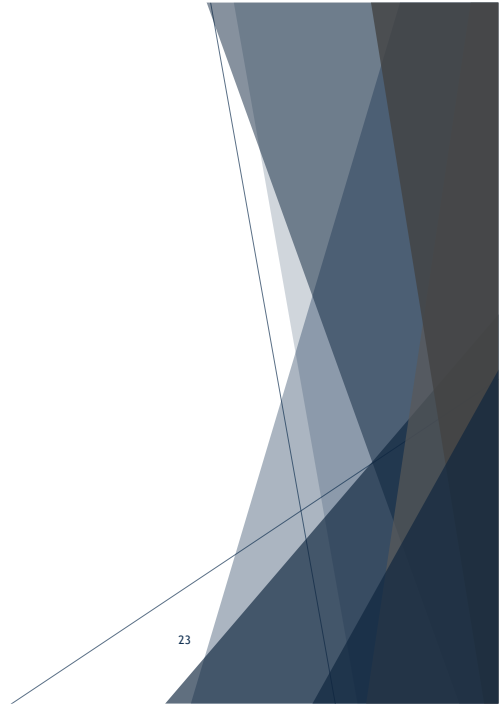
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Open Forum



Slide 23



Closing Remarks



Slide 24

